

HOW TO...

Write a winning personal statement for *Law School*

What Admissions Need to See

The personal statement is your interview on paper. It is your chance to show the admissions committee who you are and why you want to attend law school. What makes you a winning candidate and what attributes do you bring to the incoming class. It is your opportunity to go beyond your GPA and your LSAT score. Tell a good story and make sure every sentence leads into the next. The writing must be excellent, this usually takes several drafts. Start with a powerful hook sentence and end with expressing gratitude for this academic opportunity. The tone of the paper should be positive. Write mostly about you, not your relative or another entity.

Length: double spaced, 12 font and no longer than 2 pages

Purpose: 1) Provide the committee a picture of who you are
2) Demonstrate your reason for wanting to pursue law school
3) Your chance to stand out beyond a number

An exercise which will help you write: Ask yourself the following questions: when was the first time I thought about law school and why? What do I feel when I hear the word lawyer or law firm or justice. Have you personally experienced or witnessed an injustice? Did this change your life and if so, how?

Begin Writing:

Start with a lead sentence and begin to tell your story. Check spelling, grammar and punctuation. Check for run on sentences and make sure your essay flows. Eliminate useless filler words and re read and re write until you have your perfect essay. Is your writing clear? Can the reader understand what you are trying to share?



Yeshiva University

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Key Components to Consider:

Who are you? What are your career plans/aspirations? When did your interest in law school develop? Where do you hope to have an impact? Have you demonstrated your interest in this field and what makes you a unique candidate? (Demonstrate do not state, relate rather than pontificate)

Tell your story, do not rehash your resume, share what you have learned and what you hope to achieve from attending law school.

Avoid the following:

Avoid cliches, various dramatic phrases and quotations. Do not write anything negative about yourself, your profession or anyone else.

Do:

Talk about helping people and keep it positive. Be truthful, remember everything in your personal statement is subject to discussion should you have an interview.

Supports

Your Pre-Law Advisor, the Writing Center, & The Shevet Glaubach Center for Career Strategy and Professional Development

Shevet Glaubach Center for
Career Strategy and Professional Development
Email us: CareerStrategy@yu.edu
Schedule an appointment: bit.ly/YUCL



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